



Structured Administration & Supply Arrangement (SASA) Picolax® and PicoPrep® (Pre Admission Clinic)

Issuing Authority

Health Service	Sir Charles Gairdner Osborne Park Health Care Group (SCGOPHCG)
Address	Hospital Avenue, Nedlands, Western Australia
Contact	6457 2348

Authorisations

Practitioners:	SCGOPHCG Registered Nurse SCGOPHCG Medication Competent Enrolled Nurse
Practice Setting:	Pre Admission Clinic
Qualification:	Registered with the Nursing & Midwifery Board of Australia Enrolled Nurse who has completed a Board-approved qualification in administration of medicines
Authorisation:	Supply
Risk rating:	Low
Patients	Eligible outpatients as outlined within inclusion criteria of this SASA

Approved Sites

Site	Site Address
1.	Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital, Hospital Avenue, Nedlands, WA
2.	Osborne Park Hospital, Osborne Place, Stirling, WA

Picolax® and PicoPrep®

Route:	Per Oral	Brand:	Picolax® or PicoPrep®
Form:	Powder for oral solution	Strength:	Each 20 g sachet of Picolax® contains: 10 mg sodium picosulfate; 7.9 g magnesium carbonate; 11.8 g citric acid Each 20 g sachet of PicoPrep® contains: 10.3 mg sodium picosulfate; 7.4 g magnesium carbonate; 12.2 g citric acid
Dose:	1 - 2 sachets (250 - 500 mL)	Quantity:	Maximum of 2 sachets
Instructions:	Detailed written instructions for food & drink consumption prior to surgery/procedure should be given to the patient. <i>The timing and number of sachets to be taken varies depending on the surgery/procedure undertaken. Ensure patient is given specific written instructions regarding the timing and number of sachets to be taken.</i> In general: Slowly add the contents of 1 sachet of Picolax®/PicoPrep® to a large glass (250 mL) of water. Stir gently until effervescence ceases. Bowel motion usually starts after about 1 hour, usually within 3 hours, which normally removes the bowel contents.		
Administration Notes:	Advise patient to: - Keep medicine in the sachet until it is time to mix and take a dose. - Keep Picolax®/PicoPrep® powder in a cool, dry place where it stays below 25°C.		

	See Picolax®/PicoPrep® consumer medicine information booklet for more detailed information regarding preparation and administration. Oral medication taken within one hour of the commencement of the administration of Picolax®/ PicoPrep® may be flushed from the gastrointestinal tract and not absorbed. The use of antibiotics may reduce the effectiveness of Picolax®/ PicoPrep® since sodium picosulfate is broken down by colonic bacteria to form the active substance.
Patient Inclusion:	Patients requiring emptying and cleansing of the large bowel in preparation for gastrointestinal diagnostic or surgical procedures.
Patient Exclusion:	Known documented allergy to the active substance or to any of the excipients. Gastrointestinal obstruction (partial or complete), gastric retention, bowel perforation (frank or suspected), severe colitis (especially toxic megacolon), severe dehydration, clinically significant kidney impairment, stoma and ileus contraindicated.
Patient Precautions:	Use with caution in patients with active inflammatory bowel disease, impaired renal function, pre-existing electrolyte disturbances (eg hypokalaemia), dehydration, heart conditions and in the elderly – fluid and electrolyte disturbances can occur (monitor closely). Diabetic patients: a liquid diet may affect blood glucose levels and diabetic medications may require adjustment. Picolax®/PicoPrep® inactivates the low dose contraceptive pill, discuss risks with patients taking contraceptive medication. Picolax®/PicoPrep® may interact with medicines for heart conditions, discuss risks with patient.
Safety in Pregnancy/ Breastfeeding:	Pregnancy: consider alternative. Breastfeeding: safe to use.
Documentation:	Outpatients: Outpatient notes inclusive of MR 410

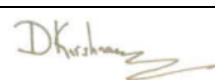
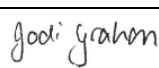
	• Electronically via approved electronic software (i.e. hospital approved DMR)
Adverse Effects:	Headache, dizziness, nausea, abdominal fullness and bloating are the most common reactions. Abdominal cramps, vomiting, and anal irritation occur less frequently. These adverse effects are usually transient and subside rapidly. Hypersensitivity and anaphylactic reactions are rare adverse reactions. Life threatening dehydration and/or electrolyte disturbances may occur in 'patient precautions' group.

Related policies, procedures, and guidelines

SCGOPHCG Guidelines

- [Medicines Management](#)
- [Clinical Practice Guideline – Gastrointestinal Endoscopic Procedures](#)

1. Australian Medicines Handbook. Saline laxatives. In: Australian Medicines Handbook [Internet]. Adelaide (South Australia): Australian Medicines Handbook; 2025 [cited 2025 Aug 04] Available from: [Australian Medicines Handbook \(health.wa.gov.au\)](https://www.austlii.edu.au/au/other/australianmedicineshandbook/1-10-laxatives/1-10-1-saline-laxatives.html)
2. Structured Administration and Supply Arrangements, Department of Health. Available at https://www.health.wa.gov.au/Articles/S_T/Structured-Administration-and-Supply-Arrangements
3. [SCGOPHCG Structured Administration and Supply Arrangements \(SASAs\)](#)
4. AusDI [Internet]. St Leonards (NSW): Health Communication Network; c2025. Picolax; [updated 2012 Dec; cited 2025 Aug 04]. Available from: [Picolax - AusDI](#)
5. Therapeutic Goods Administration - ARTG [Internet]. Woden (ACT): Australian Government – Department of Health, Disability and Ageing; 2024. PicoPrep; [updated 2021 Apr 28; cited 2025 Aug 18]. Available from: [pdf](#)
6. Pregnancy and Breastfeeding Medicines Guide [Internet]. Melbourne (VIC): The Royal Women's Hospital; Sodium picosulfate [cited 2025 Aug 04]. Available from: [sodium picosulfate | PBMG](#)

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Position	Executive Director	Date:	18/09/2025
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